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FROM BARAMULLA TO THE BIG LEAGUE



Auqib Nabi's ability to make the ball dance to his tunes in either direction has drawn everyone's attention. An IPL breakthrough now **beckons** him.

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There was a period of play during Jammu & Kashmir's Ranji Trophy match against Delhi in early November that truly encapsulates what Auqib Nabi is capable of with the cherry in hand. In the 63rd over of Delhi's first innings, Nabi extracted a tinge of outward movement, enough to take the shoulder of the bat as Hrithik Shokeen pressed forward to defend with soft hands. One ball later, first-class debutant Manan Bharadwaj was welcomed with a booming in-swinging yorker, trapping him in front.

Just two overs prior, Nabi had forced an edge off Anuj Rawat with a ball moving away from the left-hander. This ability to make the ball dance to his tunes in either direction has drawn everyone's attention. **Most domestic pacers are only potent in moving the ball one way, allowing batters to negotiate their threat to an extent. But Nabi manages to gain the upper hand in the mental battle by creating a seed of doubt in the opponent's mind.**

"When I started, I only had the outswing. It used to come out well. When I managed to get some inswing, the outswing went away. This went on for a couple of years. I had to practise